2026/2027

Forsyth County Schools — Denmark High School

High School Course Syllabus (CTAE)

Financial Literacy

Initials _____ (every page initialed by parent/guardian)
Updated July 2026

TEACHER INFORMATION

Teacher Name: Steven Weimann

Contact Information: f46637@forsythk12.org | (470) 533-2521 X511279

Availability for Extra Help: Available for extra help from 8:00–8:20 am and 3:45–4:00 pm. Meetings are by appointment only, and I am willing to meet outside of these hours with plenty of notice.

COURSE INFORMATION

Course Description:

How money smart are you? Step into this course specifically designed for high school students to understand the importance of the financial world, including planning and managing money wisely. Areas of study taught through application in personal finance include sources of income, budgeting, banking, consumer credit, credit laws and rights, personal bankruptcy, insurance, spending, taxes, investment strategies, savings accounts, mutual funds and the stock market, buying a vehicle, and living independently. Based on the hands-on skills and knowledge applied in this course, students will develop financial goals, and create realistic and measurable objectives to be MONEY SMART! Through project-based learning activities and tasks, students will apply mathematical concepts in realistic scenarios and will actively engage by applying the mathematics necessary to make informed decisions related to personal finance. Financial Literacy places great emphasis on problem solving, reasoning, representing, connecting and communicating financial data. Various forms of technologies and internet research will be highlighted to expose students to the resources available when managing personal financial goals. Employability skills are integrated into activities, tasks, and projects throughout the course standards to demonstrate the skills required by business and industry. Competencies in the co-curricular student organization, Future Business Leaders of America (FBLA), are integral components of the employability skills standard for this course. Financial Literacy is the second course in the Business Accounting and Financial Services pathways in the Finance Cluster. Students enrolled in this course should have successfully completed Introduction to Business & Technology.

Course Standards:

GADOE - 07.42600 — Georgia Financial Literacy CTAE Course Standards (link).

Materials Needed:

Students are highly recommended to bring their own calculator. Recommended calculators would be a scientific or graphing calculator (ex. Texas Instruments TI-30, TI-36, or TI 80-85). Calculators built into Chromebooks and desktop computers can also suffice.

Classroom Standards Handbook:

This course is also governed by a separate Business & Finance Classroom Standards Handbook, distributed and signed at the start of the year. It provides full classroom-level detail on device/cell phone use, due dates and late work, academic integrity, AI use, professional conduct, classroom visitors, and food & drink. Where a topic is addressed in both documents (academic integrity, device/cell phone policy, and late work), this syllabus reflects the handbook's policy.

Access this course in Canvas for the most up-to-date course information, including ancillary materials and key dates.

PROJECTED COURSE TIMELINE

The table below reflects this year's unit sequence and approximate pacing (Aug 6, 2026 – May 27, 2027). Exact dates may shift slightly to accommodate the school calendar, but unit order and major assignments will remain consistent.

Unit	Approx. Timeline	Major Assignments / Assessments
1 – Foundations of Personal Finance (values, money personalities, cognitive biases, SMART goals)	2 weeks (Aug 6 – Aug 17)	Beginning-of-Year Portfolio Grade Unit 1 Glossary Quiz
2 – Careers in Finance & Income	2.5 weeks (Aug 18 – Sep 3)	Research Finance Jobs Mini-Project Units 1 & 2 Combined Test
3 – Income & Taxes	3 weeks (Sep 4 – Sep 25)	Tax Case Study Project + Presentations Unit 3 Test
4 – Budgeting & Spending Plans	5 weeks (Sep 28 – Oct 30)	Personal Budget Project (incl. Budget Crisis) + Presentations Unit 4 Test
5 – Banking & Financial Services	6 weeks (Nov 2 – Dec 11)	Bank on Your Future Project + Presentations Unit 5 Test
Semester 1 Wrap-Up	Dec 14 – Dec 17	Semester 1 Journal (100-pt Summative) Midterm Portfolio Grade & Spotlights
6 – Credit, Loans & Consumer Protection (+ Paying for College Mini-Unit)	5.5 weeks (Jan 5 – Feb 11)	Unit 6 + Paying for College Project + Presentations Combined Test
7 – Investing, Saving & Retirement	6 weeks (Feb 17 – Apr 2)	Investing Project + Presentations Unit 7 Test
8 – Insurance & Risk Management	4 weeks (Apr 12 – May 7)	Insurance Project + Presentations Unit 8 Test
Semester 2 Wrap-Up (incl. Philanthropy Mini-Unit)	May 10 – May 27	Semester 2 Journal (100-pt Summative) Final Year-End Portfolio & Spotlights Last Day of School: May 27

Final Exam Exemption: Students may exempt the final exam if they have a 90 or above course average.

DAILY JOURNAL & DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

Each class period begins with a brief written journal prompt (5-7 minutes) connecting the day's topic to students' own lives and decisions. Journals are stamped weekly for participation and submitted once per semester for a single 100-point summative grade (mid-December and mid-May). Students also maintain a running digital portfolio of major projects, which is graded at the beginning of the year, at the semester midpoint, and again at year's end.

EMPLOYABILITY SKILLS: STANDARD 1

Standard 1 across all CTAE courses focuses on demonstrating the employability skills valued by business and industry. This encompasses effective communication, creativity, critical thinking, and problem-solving abilities. It also involves displaying work readiness traits essential for workplace success and using the necessary skills to contribute productively on the job. Additionally, Standard 1 highlights the importance of maintaining a professional image through appropriate appearance, behavior, and language.

CAREER TECHNICAL STUDENT ORGANIZATION (CTSO)

Career Technical Student Organizations (CTSOs) are co-curricular organizations with leadership programs and competitive events which reflect current curriculum standards and competencies for the instructional programs they serve. Teachers infuse CTSO activities into instructional activities, helping students see the real-world value of their academic studies. The

CTSO for this course appears below, and students are encouraged to take advantage of these additional leadership opportunities.

FBLA: The mission of Georgia FBLA is to bring business and education together in a positive working relationship through innovative leadership and career development programs.

DRESS FOR SUCCESS

Career and technical education pathways in Forsyth County incorporate Dress for Success Days throughout the school year. These experiences allow students to foster confidence and continue to develop a positive self-image, while understanding the importance of dressing well for their future profession. At certain intervals throughout the course, students will analyze industry standards of the profession and study the importance of dressing well for a job interview. This will culminate in being fully prepared for Community Mock Interviews which occur as students complete a career pathway.

END OF PATHWAY ASSESSMENT / CREDENTIALS OF VALUE

Students are encouraged to choose a career pathway in 9th or 10th grade that aligns with their college and career goals. This course is part of a three-course sequence that concludes with a nationally recognized online industry credentialing assessment. This exam allows students to demonstrate the skills they've learned and may lead to earning an FCS Pathway Medallion and State Career Pathway Diploma Seals upon graduation. Student directory information may be shared with credentialing vendors offering the assessment. The technical coursework completed throughout the pathway provides the foundation needed for success on the exam, and teachers will share testing details, study guides, and other resources to support student preparation.

ASSESSMENT & GRADING

Assessment Categories:

- Formative Assessments include, but are not limited to, homework, class work, labs, investigations, practice tests, rough drafts, and sections of projects/research papers/presentations.
- Summative Assessments include, but are not limited to, unit tests, final projects, final essays, formal lab reports, final research papers, final presentations, the semester journal, and portfolio grades.

Grading Scale	Grading Weights	Grading Calculations
A = 90-100 B = 80-89 C = 70-79 F = 0-69	Formative = 25% + Summative = 75% (midterm and final exam multiplier = 1)	50% (Semester 1) + 50% (Semester 2) = Course Average

Make-up Work (Excused Absence):

Make-up work is defined as work assigned during a student's absence, not work assigned prior to an absence. Students who are absent from school have five (5) school days upon returning to school to complete makeup work. The teacher has discretion to grant a longer period of time to make up the work if there are extenuating circumstances.

Due Dates & Late Work (Classroom Standards Handbook):

Outside of excused-absence makeup above, this class follows the late work schedule from the Business & Finance Classroom Standards Handbook, distributed and signed separately at the start of the year:

On time	Full earned credit
Up to 1 week late	89% of earned credit
1–2 weeks late	80% of earned credit
More than 2 weeks late	May not be accepted; see teacher

Late work is submitted using the "Late Assignment Submission Form" in the Class Resources module on Canvas. Illness, family emergencies, school-sponsored events, and similar extenuating circumstances may qualify for a waived or reduced penalty if communicated before the deadline or as soon as reasonably possible after; documentation may be requested.

Summative Reassessment:

Summative assessments identify standards where students demonstrate or lack proficiency. Educators use assessment evidence to accurately report levels of student proficiency in a grade-level subject or course and guide next steps. To support continued learning, students may engage in one summative reassessment opportunity per semester per course.

Procedures:

- All formative assessments must be complete before a student takes a corresponding summative reassessment.
- The student must engage in re-teaching activities prior to the summative reassessment.
- The teacher collaborative team can determine one of two methods for reassessment: engage the student in re-teaching activities and reassess the standards, or engage the student in re-teaching activities and use the midterm or final exam to reassess the aligned standards.
- To ensure accuracy in grading and reporting practices, full credit is applied to all reassessments.
- When a student does not show minimal proficiency of standards on multiple summative assessments, a multi-tiered system of supports will be put in place to assist the student in reaching proficiency.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

It is the expectation of Forsyth County Schools that students exhibit academic integrity when submitting evidence of learning. When students submit evidence that does not authentically represent what they know and can do, the evidence is rendered invalid. Examples of academic dishonesty are outlined in the Family Engagement Guide & Student Handbook, The Forsyth County Schools Code of Conduct, and this classroom's Business & Finance Classroom Standards Handbook (distributed and signed separately). The classroom-level definitions and consequences below are aligned with that handbook.

What Counts as Cheating:

- Copying another student's work and submitting it as your own.
- Submitting work from websites, previous students, or any outside source without attribution.
- Allowing another student to copy your work — you are equally responsible.
- Failing to cite sources, references, or acknowledge help you received.
- Sharing assignments with peers who will submit similar or identical work.
- Using AI tools in contexts where they are prohibited, or failing to disclose permitted AI use (see the classroom's AI Use Policy).

What Is Allowed:

- Collaborating with peers to understand concepts.
- Using textbooks, Canvas materials, documentation, and course resources.
- Asking the teacher for help — always.
- Using approved AI tools within the boundaries described in the classroom AI Use Policy, with disclosure.
- Crediting a peer who helped you understand something.

Consequences for High School Students:

First Offense	Parent contact + academic integrity contract + take a different assessment with a maximum assessment score of up to 60%
Second Offense	Parent contact + loss of credit up to 100% + removal from honor clubs/societies + possible in-school suspension or out-of-school suspension
Third Offense	Parent conference + loss of credit up to 100% + possible out-of-school suspension

- Academic Integrity offenses will not reset each school year. For example: If a student has an academic integrity offense during 9th grade and another one in 10th grade, the offense in 10th grade would be considered their second overall offense.

- Standardized Assessments: Any suspicion or instances of cheating on standardized tests will be reported to the governing agency and, based on the severity of the behavior, will receive disciplinary consequences.
- Severe Offenses: Should a student engage in behavior that compromises the integrity of an assessment (i.e., theft of assessment, pictures/dissemination of content, etc.), immediate and more severe consequences (up to a disciplinary tribunal) may be applied.

**Students who face consequences for submitting work that does not reflect their own knowledge and skills may only reassess in accordance with the Academic Integrity Consequences outlined above.*

RESPONSIBLE USE OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

Artificial Intelligence refers to computer systems that are trained with data to accomplish tasks normally requiring human intelligence. AI is used across industries and communities and can serve as a helpful tool in educational settings. Students should learn how to evaluate if and when they should use AI and develop responsible and ethical practices when using AI tools. Students with Forsyth County Schools are expected to uphold the highest standards of academic integrity. This includes the responsible use of emerging technologies such as artificial intelligence.

Students will:

- Use approved age-appropriate AI tools for educational purposes only
- Follow teacher guidance on the use of AI tools
- Submit work that is fundamentally their own and provide proper citations when AI is used
- Evaluate the purpose, safety, and the trustworthiness of AI tools before use
- Review and critically assess output of AI tools recognizing that AI may contain bias and inaccuracies
- Not use AI tools to propagate harmful, misleading, offensive or inappropriate content

All members of Forsyth County Schools' community agree to follow the Forsyth County Schools Code of Conduct, school rules and commit to these responsible use guidelines.

Classroom-specific AI boundaries and disclosure requirements for this course are provided in the Business & Finance Classroom Standards Handbook.

FCS HIGH SCHOOL DISTRACTION-FREE LEARNING INFORMATION

FCS High School Cell Phone/Electronic Device Contract: In alignment with GA HB340, the Distraction-Free Education Act, which mandates that local school systems establish policies governing personal electronic device use for students in kindergarten through eighth grade, Forsyth County Schools has extended these restrictions to include high school students. Under this policy, high school students' personal electronic devices must remain secured and out of sight from 8:25 AM until the end of the school day at 3:40 PM, except for permitted use during lunch periods.

“Personal electronic device” means any portable electronic device capable of transmitting, receiving, or accessing communications, data, or media. This term includes, but is not limited to, personal laptops and headphones, smartphones, smartwatches, tablets, e-readers, smart glasses, and other devices with functionalities such as wireless communication, internet access, messaging, video recording, gaming, social media access, or data transmission.

Classroom Device Policy (Classroom Standards Handbook):

- Students use school-issued Chromebooks for all coursework; personal laptops and tablets are not permitted in this class.
- Cell phones are prohibited during the school day per school policy and are strictly enforced in this classroom — phones must be stored out of sight, not on the desk or in hand.
- Devices are closed or screen-down during direct instruction unless students are directed to use them; during work time, devices are open for course-related tasks only.
- Earbuds/headphones are not permitted unless explicitly approved for a specific activity.
- Full consequences for device and cell phone violations are outlined in the Business & Finance Classroom Standards Handbook, distributed and signed separately at the start of the year.

INSTRUCTIONAL RESOURCES AND ACCESS

All learning resources, both print and digital, are meant to support and enhance the student learning experience in this class. This year's course draws primarily on Business U (lesson texts and platform quizzes) and Next Gen Personal Finance (NGPF) Student Activity Packets and Activity Bank resources, supplemented by teacher-built glossary quizzes for each unit. Below are the names of the platforms and websites used in this course. Some web-based resources require parent permission per federal regulations. Federal laws that guide parent permission requirements are as follows:

- Children's Internet Protection Act (CIPA): The school is required by CIPA to have technology measures and policies in place that protect students from harmful materials, including those that are obscene and pornographic. Any harmful content contained within inappropriate sites will be blocked. http://fcc.gov/cgb/consumerfacts/cipa.html
- Children's Online Privacy Protection Act (COPPA): COPPA applies to commercial companies and limits their ability to collect personal information from children under 13 years of age. No personal student information is collected for commercial purposes. https://www.ftc.gov/tips-advice/business-center/guidance/complying-coppa-frequently-asked-questions-0
- Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA): FERPA protects the privacy of student education records and gives parents the right to review records. Under FERPA, schools may disclose directory information in certain circumstances. http://www2.ed.gov/policy/gen/guid/fpco/ferpa

Please review the resources below. Each website related to the curriculum resources is provided along with its privacy policy. Should you have any questions regarding these resources, immediately contact the course teacher via email or phone.

Name of Resource*	Hard Copy/Website	Privacy Policy
Business U	https://cte.stukent.com/business	https://www.stukent.com/privacypolicy/
Canvas (LMS)	https://www.instructure.com/canvas	https://www.instructure.com/policies/privacy
Pathful	https://www.virtualjobshadow.com/login/	https://www.virtualjobshadow.com/resources/policy/
Canva	https://www.canva.com	https://www.canva.com/policies/privacy-policy/

Name of Resource*	Hard Copy/Website	Privacy Policy
Google Edu Workspace	https://edu.google.com	https://policies.google.com/privacy

** The above resources are county approved. These resources may vary by school due to sequencing, pacing, curriculum design, and/or individual needs of students.*

Name of Resource**	Website	Privacy Policy
NOCTI	https://www.nocti.com	https://www.nocti.org/privacy-policy/
Kahoot	https://www.kahoot.com	https://kahoot.com/privacypolicy/
Gimkit	https://www.gimkit.com	https://www.gimkit.com/privacy
FBLA	https://www.fbla.org/	https://www.fblapbl.org/privacy-policy-2/

*** The above resources are web-based resources or assessment platforms that require parent permission. Students completing the third course in a CTAE pathway will take an End of Pathway Assessment/Credentials of Value at the end of the school year. By signing the syllabus, the parent is approving these resources. Should you have any questions regarding any of these classroom resources, please contact your student's teacher via email.*

PARENT/GUARDIAN ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I, _____, have read this course syllabus and approve of its contents. I understand that the syllabus may change in order and the projects may vary slightly throughout the year. I agree to allow my student to use each of the classroom resources listed in the learning resource section. I will support my student in following the classroom expectations outlined in this course syllabus. I agree that I am the person who is legally allowed to consent for my student, whose name is listed below.

Student Name (Print): _____

Parent/Guardian Name (Print): _____

Parent/Guardian Signature: _____

Date: _____